

God Save the King vs The Star-Spangled Banner - A1/A2 Version

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. God Save the King - with plain English

God save our gracious King, — God, please protect our kind King. Long live our noble King, — We want our King to live a long time. God save the King: — God, please protect the King. Send him victorious, — Help him to win. Happy and glorious, — Happy and great. Long to reign over us, — Rule over us for a long time. God save the King. — God, please protect the King.

2. The Star-Spangled Banner - with plain English (first four lines)

O say can you see, by the dawn's early light, — Can you see, in the early morning light, What so proudly we hailed at the twilight's last gleaming? — the flag we were proud of yesterday evening? Whose broad stripes and bright stars, through the perilous fight, — The flag has wide stripes and bright stars. During the dangerous fight, O'er the ramparts we watched, were so gallantly streaming? — we watched it flying bravely above the fort.

3. Words to know

Word	Meaning
gracious	kind
reign	rule as king/queen
dawn	early morning
flag	the colourful cloth symbol of a country
brave	not afraid
fight	a battle

4. True or false?

1. "God Save the King" asks God to protect the Queen. **(False - the King)**
 2. The Star-Spangled Banner talks about a flag. **(True)**
 3. The Star-Spangled Banner describes a calm, peaceful morning with no danger. **(False - it describes a dangerous night battle)**
 4. "God Save the King" wants the King to rule for a long time. **(True)**
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5. Simple comparison

Fill in the grid with one word each (calm / dramatic, King / flag, etc.):

	God Save the King	Star-Spangled Banner
Who or what is it about?		
Calm or dramatic?		

6. Speaking

"Which anthem do you like better? Why?" - one simple sentence is enough: "I like ____ because it is ____."

Companion file - the original anthem-comparison-activity.md is unchanged and should still be used with B1-B2 students for the fuller glossary and open discussion questions.

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Note for the teacher

Keep the original lyrics on the page (it's good for students to see real, authentic anthem text and hear it sung) – but read/present the plain-English line underneath each one so students can follow the meaning. The A1-A2 vocabulary table from the original file still applies here.

About this activity

Companion to `anthem-comparison-activity.md` – for A1-A2 students. The original lyrics are archaic, inverted 1814–1745 English – no glossary fixes that on its own. This version adds a plain-English line under each original line, and swaps the abstract discussion for matching/MCQ. ~15 min